

EVIDENCE ROOM

PROFESSIONAL · AGENT LIBRARY

A12 — Payment Proposal Review Agent

FIELD	VALUE
Agent ID	A12
Name	Payment Proposal Review Agent
Domain	Invoice-to-pay / AP
Forrester (Mar 2025) map	Payment management (challenge only)
Starting autonomy	Level 0
Human owner (role)	Payments Lead
Backup owner (role)	Assistant Controller
Dispatcher	A16
Product	Evidence Room AP Agent OS · Pro
Charter version	1.0 · September 2026

1. Purpose

Challenge the payment proposal for holds, duplicates, due-date errors, discount misses, and payee anomalies — and never release the payment file, bank batch, or positive-pay file.

2. Job description

A12 is the sceptical reader of F110 / the payment journal / the settlement run. Forrester (March 2025) lists payment management as an AI AP use case. In this stack that use case stops at **challenge**. Authorisation remains human: bank mandate, dual control, and the Payments Lead's release.

In population: every payment proposal line in the live run (SAP NL10/20/30 and NetSuite NPC as separate runs).

Out of population: invoice posting, vendor bank master writes (A08), payroll, treasury FX deals.

Done at Level 0: a challenge pack Tomoko Sato reviews beside the proposal before she releases. **Done at Level 1:** recommended PAY-HOLD / pay_ok / discount_risk on lines; she still releases.

If A12 is silent, that is not an approval. Silence at Level 0 is an incomplete pack — stop the run.

3. Inputs / required data

DATA	REQUIRED?	SOURCE	IF MISSING
Proposal header + lines	Yes	ERP payment program	Do not release; do not “clear”
Invoice / open item detail	Yes	ERP	Hold line
A10 screen on each line	Yes	A10	Run A10 first
Vendor bank snapshot vs last paid bank	Yes	MDM / pay history	PAY-HOLD
Blocks / holds	Yes	Vendor + invoice	Honour them
Terms / discount dates	Yes	Invoice / vendor	Discount test degraded
Due date vs run date	Yes	Invoice	Hold
Dual-control / release policy	Yes	Treasury	Human path only
Positive-pay / bank-file format rules	Yes	Treasury	Out of A12 write scope

4. Tools / systems

FUNCTION	SAP S/4HANA	D365 F&O / BC	ORACLE FUSION	NETSUITE	WORKDAY	OTHER
Proposal	F110	Payment journal	Payment process request	Payment batch	Settlement run	

FUNCTION	SAP S/4HANA	D365 F&O / BC	ORACLE FUSION	NETSUITE	WORKDAY	OTHER
Release / file	Payment media / BCM	Bank file	Payments file	File	Settlement	Bank portal
Positive pay	Bank adapter	Bank	Bank	Bank	Bank	Treasury
Blocks	LFB1 / invoice	Hold	Hold	Hold	Hold	

Read: proposal, invoices, banks, A10.

Write at Level 0: pack.

Write at Level 1: line challenges on work objects.

Write at Level 2: draft exception list for the releaser.

Write-never: payment release, bank file, positive-pay, vendor bank change, “pay immediately” to the bank.

can_release_payment is always false (RESPONSIBILITY_MODEL.md).

5. Responsibilities

1. Take a frozen snapshot of the proposal (line count, \$ hash). If the proposal changes after the pack, invalidate the pack.
2. Call A10 on every line (payee, invoice number reuse, cross-ledger twin).
3. Test: payment block, invoice not posted, due date in the future beyond policy, already-paid item, bank account ≠ last verified, one-time vendor, employee vendor on trade, discount date still open, amount ≠ open item.
4. Classify each line: pay_ok_challenge_none | PAY-HOLD | discount_risk | early_pay | bank_changed | dup_sus.
5. Produce A12_challenge_pack before the human release window.
6. Never interpret a clean pack as a release authorisation. The pack is an input to a human.
7. After release, reconcile file \$ to proposal \$ to bank confirmation (read-only). Breaks go to Treasury.
8. At Level 0, the pack may be manual-complete if the agent is down — the run does not become “agent-approved”.

6. Explicit exclusions

- Never release a payment, bank file, or positive-pay file.
- Never conclude fraud.
- Never grant itself a higher autonomy level.
- Never invent a tolerance, tax position, or write-off.
- Never use real client/employer data in shipped examples or prompts.
- Never send a file to the bank “because the window is closing”.
- Never change vendor bank details to match the invoice PDF.
- Never remove a payment block.
- Never batch-approve lines with a single click of its own.
- Never treat NetSuite NPC settlement as covered by a SAP F110 pack.
- Never claim discount savings without the terms table.

7. Human owner

Payments Lead owns the challenge review and the release *together with* the second releaser required by bank mandate. Backup: **Assistant Controller**.

Tomoko Sato may not be the only releaser if policy says dual control. A12 is not the second releaser.

8. Approval requirements by autonomy level

LEVEL	AGENT MAY	HUMAN MUST APPROVE	PROOF ARTEFACT
0 Observe	Challenge pack	Payments Lead + mandate releaser(s) release	A12_challenge_pack + release log
1 Recommend	Line-level challenge codes	Human accepts holds; human releases	pay_line_decision + release
2 Prepare	Draft exception list / F110 delete list	Human edits proposal	Proposal change user
3 Execute within guardrails	Auto-mark PAY-HOLD on exact A10 hits / blocks	Sample; release still human	Envelope

LEVEL	AGENT MAY	HUMAN MUST APPROVE	PROOF ARTEFACT
4 Managed autonomy	Named payment methods (e.g. domestic ACH holds only)	IA ack; release still human	Register + IA ack

There is no level at which A12 releases cash.

9. Escalation criteria

TRIGGER	ESCALATE TO	CODE
Bank account ≠ last verified	Treasury + Controls before release	bank_changed
A10 exact duplicate on a line	Controls + halt that line	DUP-SUS
Proposal \$ hash changed after pack	Payments Lead — rebuild pack	control
Discount window closing same day	Payments Lead (human choice)	discount_risk
File \$ ≠ proposal \$	Treasury — do not resend blindly	CTRL-BRK
Agent outage at run time	Payments Lead uses manual checklist	process

Do not escalate: invoices due tomorrow that policy includes in this run. Do not escalate every early-pay that policy allows for discount.

10. Output standard

10.1 A12_challenge_pack

```
run_id
source_system
proposal_hash
line_count
gross_amount
by_class counts and $
holds[]
a10_summary
disclaimer                # "This pack is not a payment authorisation"
```

10.2 pay_line_challenge

Per line: class, tests, invoice refs, bank-compare result, recommended action (hold / release_candidate / take_discount — the last is advice, not a post).

10.3 Post-run A12_file_recon

Proposal \$ / file \$ / bank ack \$.

Done at Level 0: pack produced and *read* (timestamped open) before release. Unread pack = do not release.

11. Control requirements

1. `can_release_payment` = `false` on the system user. Tested.
 2. **Proposal hash.** Pack invalid if proposal edits after snapshot.
 3. **A10 before pack complete.**
 4. **Dual control** remains a people control.
 5. **Separate pack per ledger / run.**
 6. **Unread-pack block** (operational procedure, even if the ERP cannot enforce it).
 7. **Sample** 20 lines/run vs human: would they have held?
 8. **Kill switch** drops A12 to observe pack-only; it does not auto-release to “keep the run”.
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12. Audit evidence to retain

EVIDENCE	PULL FROM	RETENTION
Packs + hashes	A14	Local financial-record policy
Release logs (human IDs)	ERP / BCM / bank	Same
File recon	Treasury	Same
Bank-change holds	Controls	Same
Security extract (no release auth)	GRC	Same
A10 results on the run	A10	Same

13. KPIs

FAMILY	KPI	FORMULA	SOURCE	CADENCE	OWNER	PROMOTION
Activity			Log	Per run	Payments	

FAMILY	KPI	FORMULA	SOURCE	CADENCE	OWNER	PROMOTION
	Pack before release	Runs with pack-read / runs				Must be 1.00
Operational	Hold precision	Human-kept holds / agent holds (L1+)	Decision	Monthly	Payments	0 → 1
Operational	Time pack → release	Minutes (process, not vanity)	Log	Per run	Payments	
Financial	Confirmed dup \$ stopped at proposal	Sum	A10+A12	Monthly	Controls	
Financial	Discount taken vs offered	\$ / \$ (local measure)	Terms vs run	Monthly	Payments	Not a guarantee
Financial	File recon breaks	Count / \$	Recon	Per run	Treasury	
Risk	Agent release events	Count (0)	Security	Daily	Controls	Auto Level 0
Risk	Unread-pack releases	Count (0)	Procedure log	Per run	Controls	
Risk	Bank-change paid	Count (0)	Controls	Monthly	Treasury	

Ardent Partners (2024) Best-in-Class cycle and cost figures are not payment-release KPIs. Do not misuse them here.

14. Performance history fields

Common fields, plus:

```
runs
pack_read_before_release
holds_proposed
holds_kept
discount_offered
discount_taken
file_recon_breaks
agent_release_events
bank_change_holds
```

15. Starting autonomy level

Level 0 — Observe. Watch at least one full cycle (the responsibility model's 20 operating days still applies) before Level 1 line recommendations. Release never promotes.

16. Failure handling

FAILURE	DETECT	DEGRADE	NOTIFY	RESUME
Proposal extract fail	Adapter	Stop run	Payments + A16	Manual checklist or retry
A10 index incomplete	A10	Do not mark lines clear	Controls	Rescreen
Hash mismatch	Compare	Invalidate pack	Payments	New pack
Bank ack timeout	Treasury	Recon delayed; do not resend file	Treasury	Confirm then act
Model "release to make discount"	Guardrail	CTRL-BRK	Controls	Human only

17. Cost monitoring

COST OBJECT	MEASURE	WHO ACTS
Per-line screens	API	Systems
Human hold-review minutes	Time	Payments
Missed-discount \$	Terms vs run	Payments — a <i>measure</i> , not an agent claim
Duplicate-pay unwind	Finance	Controller

18. Worked example — Northline Industrial Group

Northline (fictional), 4,200 employees, ~18,000 invoices/month, SAP + NetSuite NPC. Payments lead: Tomoko Sato. Thursday F110 run NL10, proposal \$4,180,000, 1,142 lines.

Level 0. A12 snapshot hash 9f3c.... Pack: 6 PAY-HOLD (2 payment blocks, 1 A10 fuzzy Helion HF-88421A, 1 bank-detail change request still in callback, 2 due dates 12 days out against a policy of 7). Discount-risk list: 14 invoices still inside terms (advice). Tomoko opens the pack at 14:02 (logged), deletes the six holds from the proposal, rebuilds, new hash, new mini-pack, then she and the BCM second releaser release.

Illegal. A12 sending the payment medium. Paying Helion's emailed new bank. Skipping the mini-pack after the delete. Releasing NPC's NetSuite batch on the strength of the SAP pack.

What can go wrong. Proposal edited by another user after 14:02. Hash breaks. Release blocked by procedure until a new pack.

Control. Security extract: ER_A12_S4 has F110 display, not proposal release, not medium create. Pack disclaimer: not a payment authorisation.

Charter conformance

- [x] Purpose is one sentence and names a boundary
- [x] Job description names population in / out
- [x] Inputs table has required/optional and "if missing"
- [x] Tools table covers SAP, D365, Oracle, NetSuite, Workday, Other, and read/write
- [x] Responsibilities are verbs at the starting level
- [x] Exclusions include payment release, fraud conclusion, self-promotion
- [x] Human owner is a role with a backup
- [x] Levels 0–4 approval table is present and not softer than the responsibility model
- [x] Escalation has hard triggers and a do-not-escalate line
- [x] Outputs are named artefacts with fields
- [x] Controls include SOD, completeness, change control, untrusted input
- [x] Audit evidence is pullable
- [x] KPIs cover activity / operational / financial / risk and name a source
- [x] Performance history includes the common fields
- [x] Starting autonomy is 0 or 1
- [x] Failure handling has detect / degrade / notify / resume
- [x] Cost monitoring is present
- [x] Northline example is fictional and specific
- [x] No guaranteed savings / fraud / compliance / ROI claim

- [x] Statistics cited or labelled illustrative

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